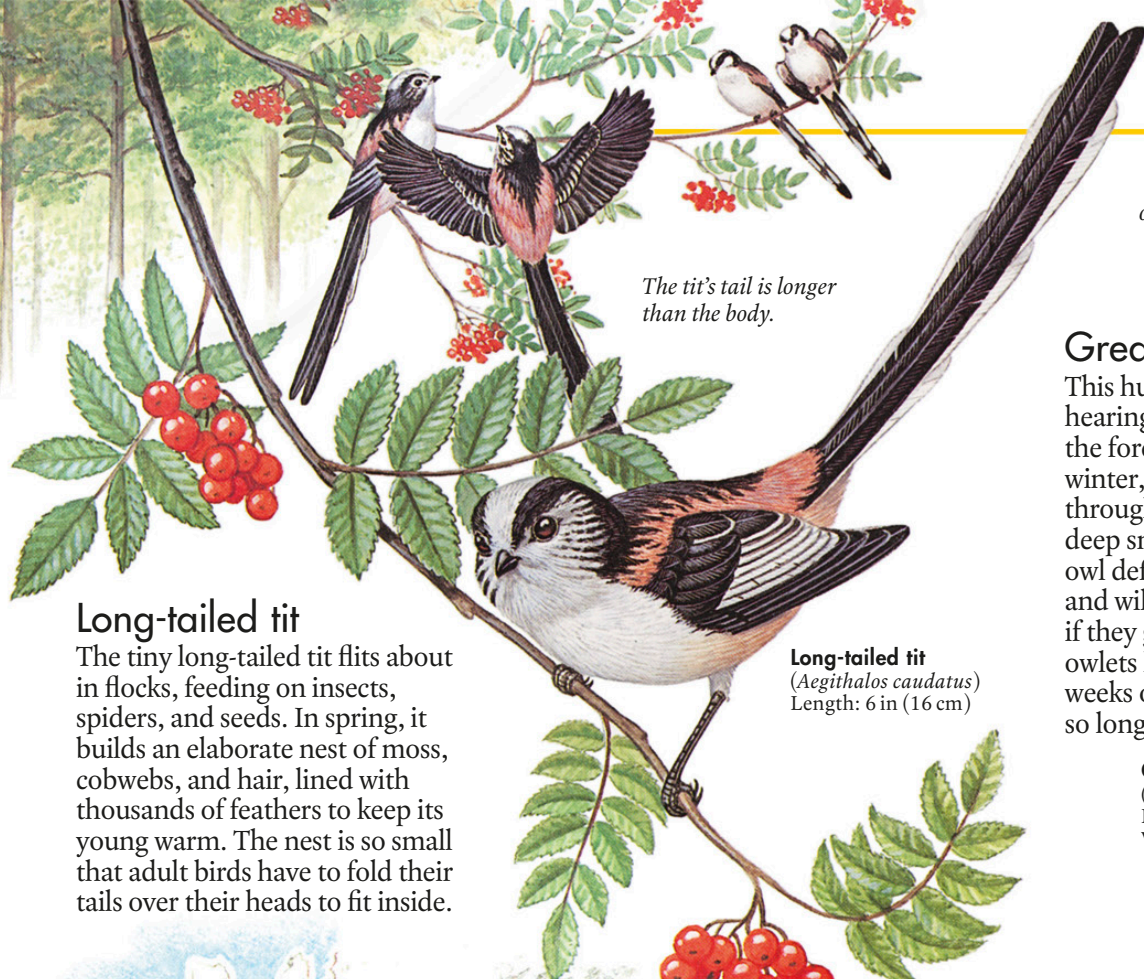




Long-tailed tit

The tiny long-tailed tit flits about in flocks, feeding on insects, spiders, and seeds. In spring, it builds an elaborate nest of moss, cobwebs, and hair, lined with thousands of feathers to keep its young warm. The nest is so small that adult birds have to fold their tails over their heads to fit inside.

The tit's tail is longer than the body.

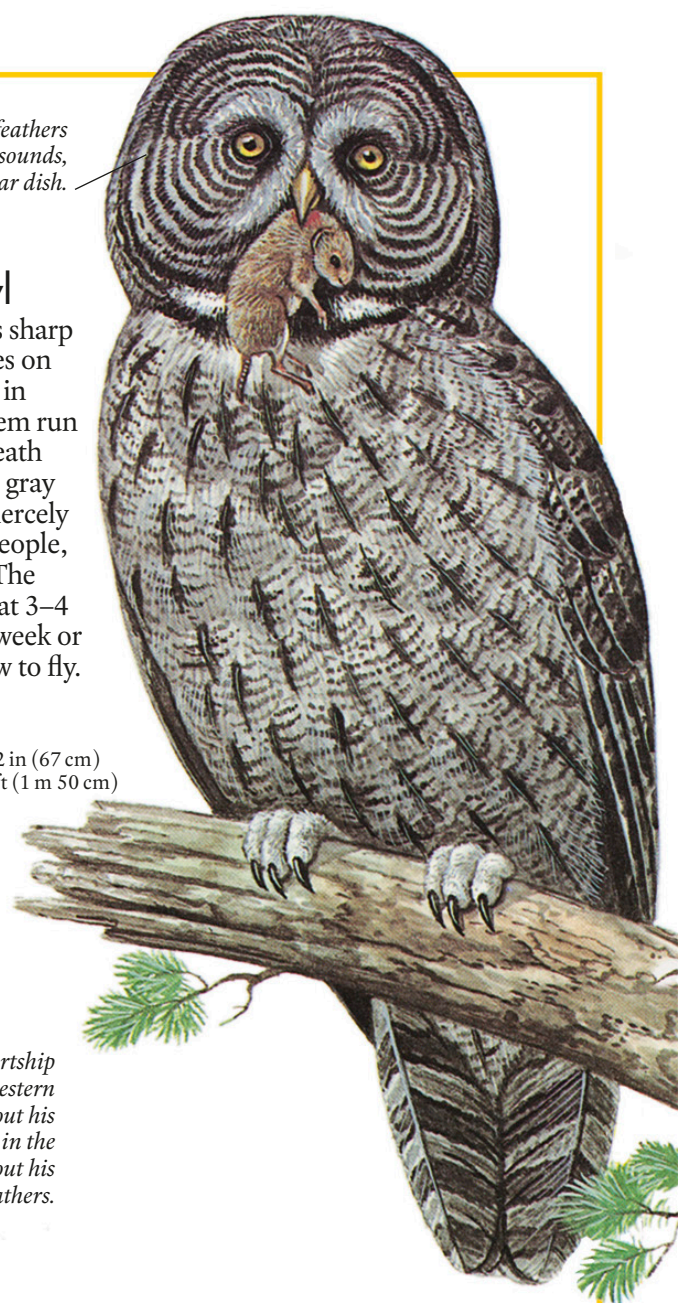
Long-tailed tit
(*Aegithalos caudatus*)
Length: 6 in (16 cm)

Large circles of feathers on the face collect sounds, like a radar dish.

Great gray owl

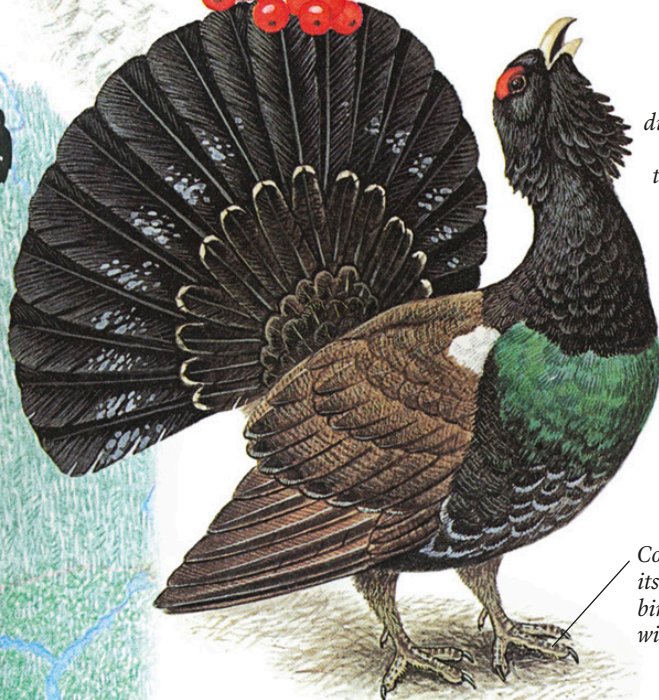
This huge owl uses its sharp hearing to detect voles on the forest floor. Even in winter, it can hear them run through tunnels beneath deep snow. The great gray owl defends its nest fiercely and will even strike people, if they get too close. The owlets leave the nest at 3–4 weeks old but take a week or so longer to learn how to fly.

Great gray owl
(*Strix nebulosa*)
Length: up to 2 ft 2 in (67 cm)
Wingspan: over 5 ft (1 m 50 cm)



During his courtship display, the male western capercaillie fans out his tail, points his bill in the air, and puffs out his throat feathers.

Western capercaillie
(*Tetrao urogallus*)
Length: male 3 ft 9 in (1 m 15 cm);
female 2 ft 1 in (64 cm)



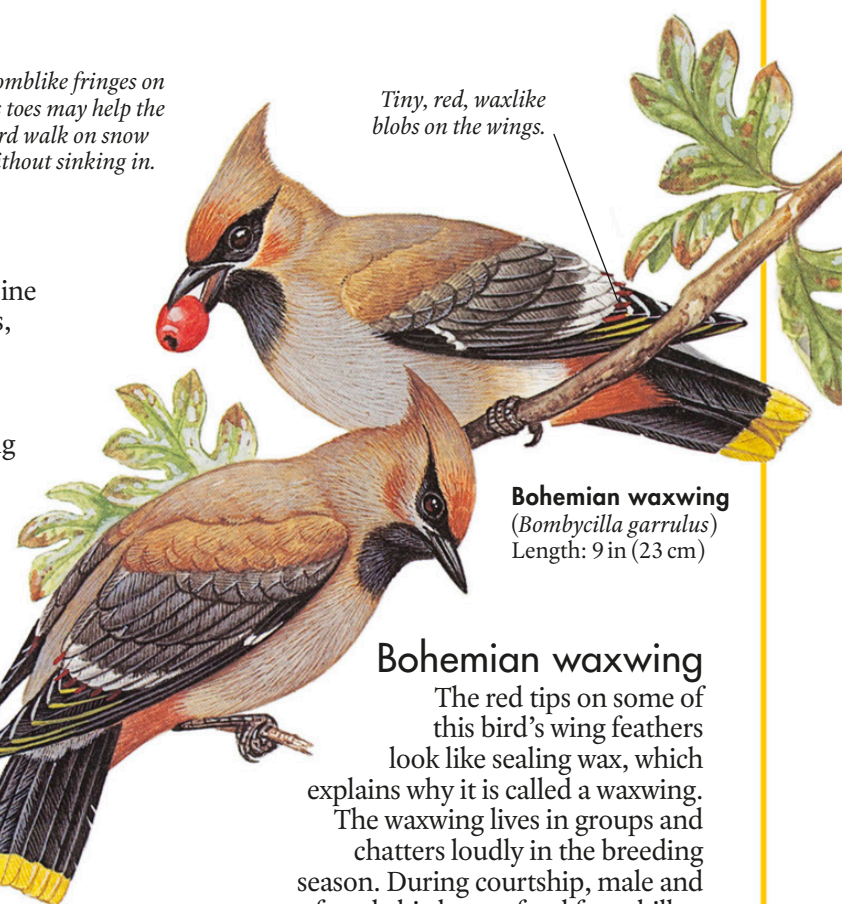
Comblike fringes on its toes may help the bird walk on snow without sinking in.

Western capercaillie

This bird lives in conifer forests, feeding on pine seeds and needles in winter and leaves, stems, and berries in summer. It nests on the forest floor. During his courtship display, the male challenges rival males with an extraordinary song, which ends with a popping and gurgling sound—like a cork being pulled out of a bottle and the drink being poured.

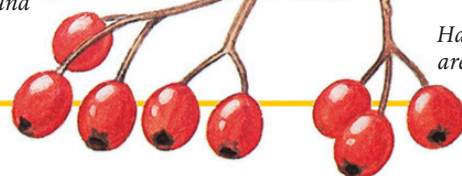
Tiny, red, waxlike blobs on the wings.

Bohemian waxwing
(*Bombycilla garrulus*)
Length: 9 in (23 cm)



Bohemian waxwing
The red tips on some of this bird's wing feathers look like sealing wax, which explains why it is called a waxwing. The waxwing lives in groups and chatters loudly in the breeding season. During courtship, male and female birds pass food from bill to bill. Its food is mainly the fruit and berries of woodland trees and shrubs.

Hawthorn berries are a favorite food.



These woodpeckers spend a lot of time on the ground searching for ants.

Eurasian green woodpecker
(*Picus viridis*)
Length: 1 ft 1 in (33 cm)

Eurasian green woodpecker

This bird is sometimes called the "yaffle," after its loud, laughing call. It has a large, daggerlike bill for probing ant hills or boring into tree trunks, and a very long tongue for licking up the insects hidden inside. It also eats fruit and seeds. During courtship, pairs of green woodpeckers spiral around trees.

Male has black and red "mustache"; female's mustache is all black.

